Leandro Laenen

Unreal Engine Technical Artist focused on optimization, shaders, Niagara systems and development pipelines & tools.

Leandro@gradientgames.net
Genk, Belgium
My Projects
LinkedIn

Skills

→ **Graphics Programming and VFX**
Materials, Niagara, HLSL, Post-Process Shaders

→ **Programming and Scripting**
Blueprints, C++

→ **Pipeline and Tools**
UE5 PCG, Blender Geometry Nodes, Source Control (Perforce, Git)

→ **Optimization**
Unreal Insights, Performance Profiling

→ **Technical Art Generalist**
Hard-Surface 3D Modeling, PBR Texturing

Languages

Dutch (Native)

English (Fluent)

French (Advanced Listening & Reading / Elementary Speaking)

Awards

Nominated: Multiplayer Game of the Year
Belgian Game Awards
Midnight Mayhem Awards Page

Experience

Gradient Games Genk, Belgium
Technical Artist / Solo Developer
September 2023 - February 2026
Programmed, designed, and shipped two commercial titles on Steam, driving 20k+ organic wishlists, managing the full lifecycle from pre-production to release and post-launch patching.
https://gradientgames.net/

Projects

Midnight Mayhem 2024 - 2025
Technical Artist / Solo Developer

- **Solved a deferred rendering pipeline limitation** for shadow-based mechanics by decoupling character visibility from the main shadow pass, engineering a localized 64x64 depth render target system costing only ~0.024ms per light source.
- **Profiled and optimized RAM, VRAM and GPU usage** (draw calls, material complexity, texture budgets) and created Niagara GPU systems to render micro-fauna at near-zero performance cost.
- **Targeted and maintained a 50fps framerate target** to secure official Steam Deck Verification.

Midnight Mayhem Technical Breakdown Available Online

The Last Explorer 2023 - 2024
Technical Artist / Solo Developer

- **Created PCG tools** to accelerate open world development and iteration.
- **Developed a Gerstner wave water shader** and buoyancy system, blending visual fidelity with real-time technical art constraints.

Technical Breakdowns

• **Nordic Island Creation Pipeline**
Engineered a pipeline to quickly create nordic islands using Blender Geometry Nodes, a UE5 complex auto-material and UE5 PCG.
https://leandrolaenen.com/islandpipeline

• **Flat-Surface 3D Sinkhole With Physics Simulation**
Engineered a way of rendering a 3d sinkhole as a flat surface without render layers, stencils or post processing. The system also allows for physics such as players falling into the hole.
https://leandrolaenen.com/sinkhole